Course Outline Template

Indian Institute of Management Calcutta

Programme : MBA

Name of the Course: **Applied Imagination: Lessons from Indian Classical Music**

Core / Elective: Elective Cap (for Elective): 45

Logic for section division and cap: performance and ensemble exercises do not scale well beyond this

Credit: 3.0

Academic Year & Term: 2026-27, Term VI

Course Coordinator: Nandita Roy

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Introduction to Course /Course Description

Course Objective and Key-takeaways from the course

Every MBA cohort now arrives fluent in dashboards and sceptical of anything that cannot be quantified. This is, in many ways, a healthy instinct and it is also precisely the instinct that is being automated fastest. Generative AI can already produce the deck, the model, the market sizing and the first draft of almost any analysis. What it cannot yet reliably produce is resonance: the quality that makes a room sit up, a story stick, a pitch land, a team follow.

Applied Imagination is built on a simple premise: that one of the most rigorous, time-tested systems humans have ever built for generating resonance is Indian classical music. The *raga*, a tightly constrained grammar that nonetheless produces infinite, emotionally precise variations is not a metaphor borrowed loosely for this course. It is treated as a working model of structure and improvisation, of timing and silence, of dialogue and deep listening, and of the long, unglamorous discipline (*riyaz*) that sits behind anything that looks effortless.

The course is taught through the sarod with live demonstration, guest musicians, listening sessions and, most importantly, participatory exercises that map directly onto situations students will face within months of graduating: pitches, negotiations, interviews, leadership narratives and the daily work of getting other people to care about an idea. No musical background is required or assumed. What is required is a willingness to treat imagination not as decoration, but as a discipline - one that can be practised, structured and assessed, just like any other managerial skill.

The course is offered in the spirit of the Indian Knowledge Systems (IKS). *Rasa* theory, *raga* grammar, *taal* and the *guru-shishya parampara* are treated here not as cultural colour but as coherent indigenous epistemologies of emotion, creativity, time and pedagogy, placed in sustained dialogue with contemporary management research. In doing so, the course extends an established scholarly lineage on organisational improvisation into the Hindustani classical tradition.

The course closes with each student composing and performing a short original narrative built using the structural tools developed across the term.

Course Objectives and Key Takeaways

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

a. Articulate, with evidence, what kinds of value imagination and resonance add in a managerial context that data and analysis alone cannot.
b. Use the structural logic of raga (fixed grammar + improvisation) as a working framework for creativity within real organisational constraints.
c. Apply *taal* (rhythmic structure) and *khali* (strategic silence) to the pacing of pitches, decks and difficult conversations.
d. Practise jugalbandi-style dialogue; real-time listening and building on others' contributions in negotiation and collaboration contexts.
e. Build and maintain a personal story bank and a sustainable practice (*riyaz*) habit for communication skills.
f. Design, rehearse and deliver an original narrative performance: the course capstone.

Course Structure: Four Modules

Module 1: *Sur* - Tuning In (Resonance and the Architecture of Listening)

This module introduces the central argument of the course (the imagination economy) and the foundational idea of *sur* tuning. Before any message can be delivered, it must be tuned to its audience. Students are introduced to *rasa* theory as an early, systematic framework for emotional effect, and to active listening as a trainable skill rather than an innate trait.

Key Takeaways:

a. Distinguish between information transfer and resonance, and identify where each is appropriate.
b. Apply *rasa*-based thinking to evaluate the emotional architecture of a pitch, deck or campaign.
c. Practise tuning the same core message for different audiences without losing its substance.

Module 2: *Raga* - Constraint and Creativity (Structure as a Generator of Originality)

This module uses the grammar of *raga*: a fixed set of permitted notes and movements that generates near-infinite variation as a working model for creativity under real constraints (budget, brand guidelines, regulation, time). Includes a live sarod demonstration of a single *raga* performed in contrasting moods, and a hands-on improvisation workshop using real business briefs.

Key Takeaways:

a. Reframe constraint as a generative tool rather than an obstacle to creativity.
b. Improvise confidently within a fixed structure: a skill directly transferable to pitching under real-world limitations.
c. Use the idea of *gharana* (lineage/style) to analyse organisational culture and brand voice.

Module 3: *Taal, Khali* and *Jugalbandi* (Rhythm, Silence and Dialogue)

This module focuses on time: the rhythmic cycle (*taal*) that structures pacing, the empty beat (*khali*) that carries as much meaning as sound, and *jugalbandi* - the real-time, unscripted dialogue between two musicians. A guest musician joins for a live *jugalbandi* demonstration, which then frames a negotiation simulation built around call-and-response rather than argument-and-counter-argument.

Key Takeaways:

a. Pace a narrative deliberately, using structure to build toward (or deliberately withhold) a climax.
b. Use strategic silence as a communication tool in negotiation and difficult conversations.
c. Practise dialogic listening: building on what was just said, rather than waiting to make a pre-planned point.

Module 4: *Riyaz* and the Capstone (Practice, Composition and Performance)

The final module addresses the discipline behind all of the above: *riyaz*, or sustained daily practice, and the *guru-shishya* tradition of long-term, individualised feedback. Students build a personal story bank of experiences structured using the tools from earlier modules, then perform an original capstone narrative in front of peers.

Key Takeaways:

a. Build a sustainable personal practice for communication skills, beyond the life of the course.
b. Maintain a reusable repertoire of structured personal and professional narratives.

c. Design, rehearse and deliver an original narrative performance under real audience conditions.

Programme Level Learning Goals (7)

Objectives	Learning Goals
***Sur* - Tuning In (Resonance and the Architecture of Listening)**	**1(j), 3(a), 4 (a,b), 6(b), 7(a)** 1. Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organizational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations j. Acquire the ability to present a structured analysis of managerial situation/s using various strands of interpretations 3. Develop a global perspective that is built upon knowledge of economic, technological, regulatory and political forces that are shaping a new international order in the 21st century a. Familiarize with global factors/phenomenon affecting the business scenario 4. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same a. Acquire the ability to organize the thought process b. Demonstrate understanding of main points 6. Acquire capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings b. Acquire the ability to interpret and apply knowledge of concepts 7. Acquire the leadership qualities and the competence needed for leading organizational change

	a. Acquire the ability to apply structured analytical thinking to solve an organizational problem
***Raga* - Constraint and Creativity (Structure as a Generator of Originality)**	**I(b,j), 4 (a,b,d), 6(c), 7(b,c)** 1. Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organizational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations b. Develop critical thinking ability through analytical treatment of important contemporary problems and issues j. Acquire the ability to present a structured analysis of managerial situation/s using various strands of interpretations 4. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same a. Acquire the ability to organize the thought process b. Demonstrate understanding of main points d. Acquire the ability to customize messages/ solutions for diverse managerial situations 6. Acquire capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings c. Acquire the ability to interpret and apply knowledge of concepts 7. Acquire the leadership qualities and the competence needed for leading organizational change a. Acquire the ability to apply structured analytical thinking to solve an organizational problem

	b. Demonstrate understanding of complex human issues arising from the implementation of change
***Taal, Khali* and *Jugalbandi* (Rhythm, Silence and Dialogue)**	**1 (e,j), 4(a,b), 6(d), 7(d)** 1. Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organizational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations e. Acquire the ability to present a structured analysis of managerial situation/s using various strands of interpretations j. Acquire the ability to present a structured analysis of managerial situation/s using various strands of interpretations 4. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same a. Acquire the ability to organize the thought process b. Demonstrate understanding of main points 6. Acquire capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings c. Acquire the ability to interpret and apply knowledge of concepts 7. Acquire the leadership qualities and the competence needed for leading organizational change d. Understand individuals' and groups' behavior and motivation
***Riyaz* and the Capstone (Practice, Composition and Performance)**	**1(a,b), 4(a,b,d,e), 6(c,d), 7(d)** 1.Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and

	find solutions to organizational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations a. Attain theoretical and practical understanding of the functions and processes involved in managing an organization b. Develop critical thinking ability through analytical treatment of important contemporary problems and issues 4. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same a. Acquire the ability to organize the thought process b. Demonstrate understanding of main points d. Acquire the ability to customize messages/solutions for diverse managerial situations e. Acquire the ability to deliver a professional quality formal presentation by exhibiting clarity and appropriate pace, coherent structure, credibility, effective use of visual aids, appropriate body language 6. Acquire capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings c. Acquire the ability to design appropriate responses to solve identified problems by using appropriate tools, techniques & framework taught in courses d. Acquire the ability to apply structured analytical thinking to solve an organizational problem 7. Acquire the leadership qualities and the competence needed for leading organizational change d. Understand individuals' and groups' behavior and motivation

Learning Goals

1. Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organisational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations

2. Develop and apply ethical values to analyse and solve organisational problems

3. Develop a global perspective that is built upon knowledge of economic, technological, regulatory and political forces that are shaping a new international order in the 21st century

4. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same

6. Acquire capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings

7. Acquire the leadership qualities and the competence needed for leading organizational change

International Components in your course (if any)

Guided listening for understanding collaborative ventures between Indian and Western traditions of music.

Pre-requisites

Openness to participatory, performance-based exercises is essential; no musical training required. Builds on themes from Inside Storytelling: Theories and Praxis for Communication and Management but does not require it as a pre-requisite.

Required Text Book(s)

None

Recommended Reading

Acar, Oguz A., Murat Tarakci, and Daan van Knippenberg. "Why Constraints Are Good for Innovation." *Harvard Business Review*, November–December 2019.

Agrawal, Ajay, Joshua Gans, and Avi Goldfarb. *Prediction Machines: The Simple Economics of Artificial Intelligence.*Boston: Harvard Business Review Press, 2018. (Chapters 1–2.)

Amabile, Teresa M. "How to Kill Creativity." *Harvard Business Review*, September–October 1998.

Anderson, Chris. "How to Give a Killer Presentation." *Harvard Business Review*, June 2013.

Barrett, Frank J. "Creativity and Improvisation in Jazz and Organizations: Implications for Organizational Learning." *Organization Science* 9, no. 5 (1998): 605–622.

Barrett, Frank J. *Yes to the Mess: Surprising Leadership Lessons from Jazz.* Boston: Harvard Business Review Press, 2012. (Chapters 1 and 3.)

Bharata. *Natya Shastra*, Chapter 6 (the rasa chapter). Course handout, translation.

Clayton, Martin. *Time in Indian Music: Rhythm, Metre, and Form in North Indian Rag Performance.* Oxford: Oxford University Press, 2000. (Introductory chapter, excerpted to approx. 15 pp.)

Csikszentmihalyi, Mihaly. *Flow: The Psychology of Optimal Experience.* New York: Harper & Row, 1990. (Chapter 4.)

Curhan, Jared R., Jillian J. Jordan, Adam Eric Greenberg, and Robert R. Wilson. "Silence Is Golden: Extended Silence, Deliberative Mindset, and Value Creation in Negotiation." *Journal of Applied Psychology* 107, no. 1 (2022): 78–94.

Denning, Stephen. "Telling Tales." *Harvard Business Review*, May 2004.

Duarte, Nancy. *Resonate: Present Visual Stories that Transform Audiences.* Hoboken, NJ: Wiley, 2010. (Chapters 1–2 and 4.)

Elsbach, Kimberly D. "How to Pitch a Brilliant Idea." *Harvard Business Review*, September 2003.

Ericsson, K. Anders, Michael J. Prietula, and Edward T. Cokely. "The Making of an Expert." *Harvard Business Review*, July–August 2007.

Ericsson, K. Anders, Ralf Th. Krampe, and Clemens Tesch-Römer. "The Role of Deliberate Practice in the Acquisition of Expert Performance." *Psychological Review* 100, no. 3 (1993): 363–406.

Fisher, Roger, and William Ury. *Getting to Yes: Negotiating Agreement Without Giving In.* 3rd ed. New York: Penguin, 2011. (Chapters 1–2.)

Ganz, Marshall. "Public Narrative, Collective Action, and Power." In *Accountability Through Public Opinion: From Inertia to Public Action*, edited by Sina Odugbemi and Taeku Lee, 273–289. Washington, DC: World Bank, 2011.

Goffman, Erving. *The Presentation of Self in Everyday Life.* New York: Doubleday, 1959. (Introduction and Chapter 1, excerpted.)

Green, M. C., and T. C. Brock. "The Role of Transportation in the Persuasiveness of Public Narratives." *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 79, no. 5 (2000): 401–421.

Ibarra, Herminia, and Kent Lineback. "What's Your Story?" *Harvard Business Review*, January 2005.

Isaacs, William. *Dialogue and the Art of Thinking Together.* New York: Currency, 1999. (Chapter 1.)

Itzchakov, Guy, and Avraham N. Kluger. "The Power of Listening in Helping People Change." *Harvard Business Review*, May 2018.

Khan, Amjad Ali. *Master on Masters.* New Delhi: Penguin Random House India, 2017. (Selected essays.)

Klein, Gary. *Sources of Power: How People Make Decisions.* Cambridge, MA: MIT Press, 1998.

Kram, Kathy E. "Phases of the Mentor Relationship." *Academy of Management Journal* 26, no. 4 (1983): 608–625.

Leonard, Kelly, and Tom Yorton. *Yes, And: How Improvisation Reverses "No, But" Thinking.* New York: Harper Business, 2015. (Chapter 1.)

Levitin, Daniel J. *This Is Your Brain on Music: The Science of a Human Obsession.* New York: Dutton, 2006.

Malhotra, Deepak, and Max H. Bazerman. "Investigative Negotiation." *Harvard Business Review*, September 2007.

McKee, Robert, interviewed by Bronwyn Fryer. "Storytelling That Moves People." *Harvard Business Review*, June 2003.

Munter, Mary, and Lynn Hamilton. *Guide to Managerial Communication.* Boston: Pearson, current edition. (Chapter on audience strategy.)

Murphy, Kate. *You're Not Listening: What You're Missing and Why It Matters.* New York: Celadon Books, 2020. (Chapter 1.)

Neuman, Daniel M. *The Life of Music in North India: The Organization of an Artistic Tradition.* Chicago: University of Chicago Press, 1990 [1980]. (Chapters on gharanas and on discipleship, excerpted.)

Pink, Daniel H. *A Whole New Mind: Why Right-Brainers Will Rule the Future.* New York: Riverhead Books, 2005. (Part One: "High Concept, High Touch.")

Pollock, Sheldon, ed. and trans. *A Rasa Reader: Classical Indian Aesthetics.* New York: Columbia University Press, 2016. (Introduction, excerpted to approx. 15–20 pp.)

Raja, Deepak. *Hindustani Music: A Tradition in Transition.* New Delhi: D.K. Printworld, 2005. (Selected essay.)

Reeves, Martin, and Jack Fuller. *The Imagination Machine: How to Spark New Ideas and Create Your Company's Future.*Boston: Harvard Business Review Press, 2021. (Introduction and Chapter 1.)

Ruckert, George. *Music in North India: Experiencing Music, Expressing Culture.* New York: Oxford University Press, 2004.

Sawyer, Keith. *Group Genius: The Creative Power of Collaboration.* New York: Basic Books, 2007. (Chapter 1.)

Schein, Edgar H. *Humble Inquiry: The Gentle Art of Asking Instead of Telling.* Oakland, CA: Berrett-Koehler, 2013. (Chapters 1–2.)

Schein, Edgar H. *Organizational Culture and Leadership.* 5th ed. San Francisco: Jossey-Bass, 2016. (Chapters 1–2.)

Shankar, Ravi. *Raga Mala: The Autobiography of Ravi Shankar.* Edited by George Harrison. Rev. ed. New York: Welcome Rain Publishers, 1999. (Chapters on training under Baba Allauddin Khan in Maihar.)

Stokes, Patricia D. *Creativity from Constraints: The Psychology of Breakthrough.* New York: Springer, 2005. (Chapter 1.)

Wade, Bonnie C. *Music in India: The Classical Traditions.* New Delhi: Manohar, 2001 [1979]. (Chapters on raga grammar and on taal.)

Weick, Karl E. "Improvisation as a Mindset for Organizational Analysis." *Organization Science* 9, no. 5 (1998): 543–555.

Zenger, Jack, and Joseph Folkman. "What Great Listeners Actually Do." *Harvard Business Review*, July 2016.

Listening List (Indicative)

No musical literacy is assumed. Where a recording runs longer, students will be directed to a specific timestamp range by the instructor. Links point to publicly available recordings on YouTube; where a commercial studio recording exists, the source album is also cited for library/purchase reference. All recordings remain the copyright of their respective performers, labels, and estates; links are provided for educational listening only.

L1 Ustad Amjad Ali Khan (sarod), with Ustad Sabir Khan (tabla)

Raga Bageshri

Structure: Alaap, Jor & Jhala (from 0:00); Vilambit Gat set to Roopak Taal (from 27:48); Drut Gat set to Teentaal (from 56:00).

Used for: Session 2 (alap opening, tuning before playing), Session 8 (jhala as a model of fixed-yet-improvised structure), Session 16 (vilambit development as sustained riyaz).

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=z4CogWM1Tis

L2a Ustad Ali Akbar Khan (sarod), with Aashish Khan (sarod) and Ustad Zakir Hussain (tabla)

Raga Nat Bhairav

Live recording, Sawai Gandharva Bhimsen Mahotsav, Pune, 1982.

Used for: Session 3, as the "gravity/awe" pole of the rasa-contrast exercise (paired with L2b).

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qdcIR3tB5Xo

L2b Ustad Ali Akbar Khan (sarod)

Raga Bageshri

All India Radio recording, 1960.

Used for: Session 3, as the contrasting romantic/nostalgic (*shringar*) pole of the rasa exercise; Session 4, replayed unlabelled as a blind raga-recognition exercise.

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=sNnFI0S8QJ4

L3 Ustad Ali Akbar Khan (sarod), with Mahapurush Mishra (tabla)

Raga Chandranandan

Aochar (unmetered opening), followed by *Vilambit* and *Drut Gat* in *Teentaal*. *Chandranandan* ("moonstruck") was composed by Ali Akbar Khan in the late 1940s, blending four existing evening ragas (*Malkauns, Chandrakauns, Nandakauns* and *Kaushi Kanada*); it is a rare documented case of a new raga created within, and immediately accepted by, the inherited grammar.

Commercial studio recording also available as "Chandranandan," Signature Series, Vol. 1 (AMMP, 1994/2005). Used for: Session 6, illustrating raga grammar as generative rather than limiting; Session 17, as a work of Ali Akbar Khan, disciple of Baba Allauddin Khan.

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=_CtXORtvvYM

L5a Pandit Nikhil Banerjee (sitar), with Ustad Faiyaz Khan (tabla)

Raga Malkauns

Alaap, Jod, followed by *Gats* in *Vilambit* and *Drut Teentaal* (16 beats). *Maihar gharana*.

Used for: Session 9, gharana contrast, paired with L5b (same raga, different gharana).

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=ssO9fHiDJrg

L5b Ustad Vilayat Khan (sitar), with Ustad Sabir Khan (tabla)

Raga Malkauns

Live recording, Malkauns Samaroha, Calcutta, 30 November 1985. *Imdadkhani* (Etawah) *gharana*.

Used for: Session 9, *gharana* contrast, paired with L5a.

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=RG3wBRjoPos

L6 Ustad Zakir Hussain (tabla)

Tabla Solo in Teentaal

Recorded 26 January 1986, Calcutta.

Used for: Session 11 (counting the 16-beat cycle and locating sam, beat 1); Session 12 (locating *khali*, the unstruck beat 9); Session 15 (*sawaal-jawaab* model).

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BWVolb7wQgw

L7 Pandit Ravi Shankar (sitar) and Ustad Ali Akbar Khan (sarod), with Ustad Alla Rakha (tabla)

Raga: Hem Bihag

Live recording, Philharmonic Hall, New York, October 1972.

Album: In Concert 1972 (Apple Records, 1973; produced by George Harrison, Zakir Hussain, and Phil McDonald). Used for: Session 13, within-tradition *jugalbandi* — a *sarod/sitar* dialogue between two disciples of Baba Allauddin Khan.

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=BUrYg3eOq8A

L8 Yehudi Menuhin (violin) and Pandit Ravi Shankar (sitar), with Ustad Alla Rakha (tabla)

Swara-Kakali (based on Raga Tilang)

Recorded following the duo's 1966 Bath Festival performance.

Album: West Meets East (His Master's Voice, UK, January 1967; Angel Records, US, June 1967). Grammy Award, Best Chamber Music Performance, 1968. Used for: Session 13, cross-tradition jugalbandi.

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=HVaSXwPekbU

L9 Vidushi Annapurna Devi (surbahar)

Debut Surbahar Recital: Raga Kaushiki / Raga Manj Khamaj

Recorded New Delhi, 1950. Annapurna Devi, daughter of Baba Allauddin Khan and sister of Ali Akbar Khan, rarely performed publicly but trained several major musicians of the next generation, including Nikhil Banerjee.

Used for: Session 17, as the *guru* figure behind L5a and, indirectly, L3 illustrating that mastery and teaching authority in this tradition do not require public performance.

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=aGRxMJYTPZI

L10 Dr. N. Rajam (Hindustani violin), with Ajeet Pathak (tabla)

Raga Yaman (Vilambit)

Recorded for Komal Nishad, March 2009. Rajam developed the *gayaki ang* (vocal style) of violin playing, adapting a Carnatic-trained, Western-origin instrument to Hindustani vocal phrasing.

Used for: optional listening alongside Sessions 6 and 9 a case of a fixed grammar (*raga*) and a gharana-like stylistic lineage (*gayaki ang*) being translated across an instrument and a musical system.

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=50uayGiO9QA

L11 Smt. Kishori Amonkar (vocal), with Narayanrao Indorkar (tabla)

Raga Bhoop (Bhoopali)

Recorded 1971. Jaipur-Atrauli gharana.

Used for: optional listening to diversify the roster with a leading vocalist and to extend the rasa discussion (Session 3) to the voice rather than an instrument.

Link: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WfKpt-_kLdA

Course Pack Distribution to students

Course material (if required) will also be issued from the Programme office

Technology enabled learning component for your course

(You may include if required)

Session Plan

Sl. No	Theme	Session Details	Reading/Listening	Faculty
1	Why Imagination, Why Now	Framing session. The imagination economy argument: what AI and data automate, and what remains irreducibly human: resonance, judgement, presence. Short sarod demonstration to open: same phrase, three emotional colours.	Reeves, Martin, and Jack Fuller. *The Imagination Machine: How to Spark New Ideas and Create Your Company's Future.*Harvard Business Review Press, 2021. Agrawal, Ajay, Joshua Gans, and Avi Goldfarb. *Prediction Machines: The Simple Economics of Artificial Intelligence.*Harvard Business Review Press, 2018. Pink, Daniel H. *A Whole New Mind.* Riverhead, 2005. **Listening (pre-session):** Ustad Ali Akbar Khan and Pandit Nikhil Banerjee - *alaap* in Raga Bhairav. Attend to the first two minutes, where the tonic (sa) is established. Prompt: what is the musician doing before "saying" anything?	NR
2	*Sur*: Tuning as a Managerial Act	Introduction to sur (tuning/intonation) as a metaphor and a method. Discussion: what does it mean to tune a message to a room before you play it? Exercise: rewriting one message for three different audiences.	Duarte, Nancy. *Resonate: Present Visual Stories that Transform Audiences.* Wiley, 2010. Munter, Mary, and Lynn Hamilton. *Guide to Managerial Communication.* Pearson. (Chapter on audience strategy) **Listening: Live Demonstration**	RC
3	*Rasa*: The Grammar of Emotional Resonance	Introduction to *rasa* theory (*Natya Shastra*) as an early, systematic framework for emotional effect arguably the original user experience theory. Compared with	Bharata, *Natya Shastra*, Ch. 6 Pollock, Sheldon (ed. & trans.). *A Rasa Reader: Classical Indian Aesthetics.* Columbia University Press, 2016. Green, M. C., and T. C. Brock. "The Role of Transportation in the Persuasiveness of	RC

Sl. No	Theme	Session Details	Reading/Listening	Faculty
		contemporary persuasion research (transportation theory, narrative impact).	Public Narratives." *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 79 (2000): 401–421. **Listening (pre-session):** Two 5-minute excerpts in contrasting rasas - *Raga Darbari Kanara* (gravity/awe) and *Raga Kafi* (playfulness/shringar). Prompt: name the emotion before you know the raga's name.	
4	Listening as Leadership	Active listening as a trained skill, not a personality trait. Drawing on the discipline of riyaz-based listening in Hindustani music (recognising a raga within seconds). Case discussion: a leader whose listening (or failure to listen) shaped an outcome.	Zenger, Jack, and Joseph Folkman. "What Great Listeners Actually Do." *Harvard Business Review*, July 2016. Schein, Edgar H. *Humble Inquiry: The Gentle Art of Asking Instead of Telling.* Berrett-Koehler, 2013. Murphy, Kate. *You're Not Listening: What You're Missing and Why It Matters.* Celadon, 2020. **Listening: Live Demonstration**	RC
5	Module Wrap: Reading the Room	Synthesis exercise: students tune a short pitch live, in real time, in response to instructor-played audience cues (skeptical investor, anxious team, bored client). Peer feedback.	Goffman, Erving. *The Presentation of Self in Everyday Life.* 1959. Live Exercise in class	NR
6	*Raga*: Constraint as a Creative Engine	Introduction to *raga* grammar: a fixed set of permitted notes and movements that nonetheless generates infinite variation. Live sarod demonstration of	Wade, Bonnie C. *Music in India: The Classical Traditions.* Ruckert, George. *Music in North India: Experiencing Music, Expressing Culture.* Oxford University Press, 2004.	NR

Sl. No	Theme	Session Details	Reading/Listening	Faculty
		one *raga* played in two contrasting moods.	Raja, Deepak. *Hindustani Music: A Tradition in Transition.* D.K. Printworld, 2005. **Listening (pre-session):** Ali Akbar Khan, *Raga Chandranandan* — a *raga* he composed within the inherited grammar. Prompt: this *raga* did not exist before c. 1960s; everything in it is "permitted" by rules centuries older.	
7	Constraints, Creativity and the Business Brief	Connecting *raga* logic to design thinking and innovation-under-constraint. Reading discussion: does constraint kill creativity, or is it the only thing that produces it?	Acar, Oguz A., Murat Tarakci, and Daan van Knippenberg. "Why Constraints Are Good for Innovation." *Harvard Business Review*, November–December 2019. Stokes, Patricia D. *Creativity from Constraints: The Psychology of Breakthrough.* Springer, 2005. **Listening: Live Demonstration**	RC
8	The Improvisation Workshop	Hands-on session. Students receive a rigid business brief (budget, audience, time, format) plus a small set of fixed notes (mandatory phrases/ideas) and must improvise a 90-second pitch live.	Barrett, Frank J. *Yes to the Mess: Surprising Leadership Lessons from Jazz.* HBR Press, 2012. Barrett, Frank J. "Creativity and Improvisation in Jazz and Organizations: Implications for Organizational Learning." *Organization Science* 9, no. 5 (1998): 605–622. **Listening:** A short *jhala* section (fast, formulaic-yet-improvised climax)	NR
9	*Gharana*: Lineage, Style and Organisational Culture	*Gharanas* (musical lineages) as an analogy for organisational culture and brand voice: shared grammar, distinct style. Case: how two organisations tell structurally similar stories very differently.	Neuman, Daniel M. *The Life of Music in North India: The Organization of an Artistic Tradition.* University of Chicago Press, 1990 [1980]. **Listening (pre-session):** The same *raga* (*Raga Marwa*) played by two artists of different gharanas : Nikhil Banerjee (*Maihar*) vs. Vilayat Khan (*Imdadkhani/Etawah*). Prompt: same	RC

Sl. No	Theme	Session Details	Reading/Listening	Faculty
			rules, different "brand voice" - describe the difference in three adjectives.	
10	Module Wrap: The Pitch Within the Box	Improvised pitches from Session 8 are revisited, refined and re-performed with feedback. Discussion: where did structure help, and where did it constrain too much?	Elsbach, Kimberly D. "How to Pitch a Brilliant Idea." *Harvard Business Review*, September 2003.	NR
11	*Taal*: Time, Cycles and Pacing	Introduction to *taal* (rhythmic cycle) as a model for pacing a narrative: build, climax, resolution within a known structure. Exercise: compressing a 10-minute pitch into a fixed beat cycle	Clayton, Martin. *Time in Indian Music: Rhythm, Metre, and Form in North Indian Rag Performance.* Oxford University Press, 2000. **Listening (pre-session):** Zakir Hussain, a short tabla solo in teentaal (16 beats). Prompt: count the cycle; find beat 1 (*sam*) each time it returns. Notice how tension builds toward it. Live demonstration on Sarod	RC
12	*Khali*: The Power of the Unstruck Beat	The *khali* (empty/silent beat) is structurally essential, not an absence. Discussion of strategic silence in negotiation, in decks, in difficult conversations. Exercise: deliver a message where the key point is deliberately left unsaid.	Curhan, Jared R., et al. "Silence Is Golden: Extended Silence, Deliberative Mindset, and Value Creation in Negotiation." *Journal of Applied Psychology* 107, no. 1 (2022): 78–94. McKee, Robert (interview with Bronwyn Fryer). "Storytelling That Moves People." *Harvard Business Review*, June 2003. **Listening (pre-session):** Return to the *teentaal* recording; this time locate the khali (beat 9, the "empty" waved beat). Prompt: it is unstruck, yet you can hear it. Then, hear John Cage's 4'33″ as the limit case.	NR
13	*Jugalbandi*: Dialogue in Real Time	Live *jugalbandi* demonstration with a guest musician: two performers listening and	Isaacs, William. *Dialogue and the Art of Thinking Together.* Currency, 1999.	RC

Sl. No	Theme	Session Details	Reading/Listening	Faculty
		responding without a script. Discussion: what does true dialogue (vs. scripted negotiation) look like in a business context?	**Listening (pre-session):** Ravi Shankar & Ali Akbar Khan in duet (e.g., the 1972 *In Concert* recording), or Ravi Shankar & Yehudi Menuhin, *West Meets East*. Prompt: identify one moment where one musician clearly picks up and extends the other's phrase. Live demonstration on Sarod	
14	Communication as *Jugalbandi*	Simulation structured around call-and-response: each party must build on, not merely counter, the other's last move. Debrief on listening vs. waiting-to-speak.	Fisher, Roger, and William Ury. *Getting to Yes.* **Listening: In session**	NR
15	Module Wrap: Timing, Silence and the Unsaid	Students apply *taal*, *khali* and *jugalbandi* principles to a recorded mock client conversation, then re-cut it for pacing and strategic silence.	No readings: In class exercise	NR
16	*Riyaz*: Practice, Mastery and the Myth of the Shortcut	The discipline of *riyaz* (daily practice) as a direct counter to instant-output culture. Discussion: deliberate practice research, and what *riyaz* for managerial communication might look like.	Ericsson, K. Anders, Michael J. Prietula, and Edward T. Cokely. "The Making of an Expert." *Harvard Business Review*, July–August 2007. Shankar, Ravi. *Raga Mala.* (The chapters on training under Baba Allauddin Khan in Maihar) Csikszentmihalyi, Mihaly. *Flow.* Harper & Row, 1990. **Listening:** *Paltas*/*sargam* exercises or a slow-tempo vilambit development.	RC
17	*Guru-Shishya*: Feedback, Mentorship and the Long Game	The *guru-shishya parampara* as a model of sustained, individualised feedback. Application: building a personal	Kram, Kathy E. "Phases of the Mentor Relationship." *Academy of Management Journal* 26, no. 4 (1983): 608–625.	RC

Sl. No	Theme	Session Details	Reading/Listening	Faculty
		feedback loop for communication skills beyond the course.	Khan, Amjad Ali. *Master on Masters.* Penguin, 2017. **Listening (pre-session):** A recording of Baba Allauddin Khan, then his disciples (Ali Akbar Khan, Ravi Shankar, Nikhil Banerjee). Prompt: what transferred, and what didn't?	
18	Building Your Story Bank	Workshop session. Each student maps personal/professional experiences onto *raga*-like structures (a fixed shape with room for improvisation) to build a reusable repertoire for interviews, pitches and leadership moments.	Ibarra, Herminia, and Kent Lineback. "What's Your Story?" *Harvard Business Review*, January 2005. Ganz, Marshall. "Public Narrative, Collective Action, and Power." In *Accountability Through Public Opinion*, World Bank, 2011.	NR
19	Capstone Project Presentations	Students draft and rehearse their capstone: a short original narrative (origin story, pitch, or leadership story) structured using sur, raga, taal and khali. Live coaching, including optional accompaniment.		RC
20	Capstone Project Presentations	Final presentation to peers and invited guests.		NR

Evaluation Components

✔ Components	✔ Weightage
Class Participation & Live Exercises	20%
Riyaz Journal	15%
The Tuned Pitch (Mid-term)	25%
Capstone: Project Presentations	40%

Online Course Management (moodle)/course web

This outline may be filled after reading the PGP Instructors Manual

Reference Document

Aim & Objectives of the Post Graduate Programme: The overall goal of the PGP is to produce world-class management professionals with a global perspective who are competent to lead and transform organisations anywhere in the world. . Our students would:

Learning Goals

1. **Possess state-of-the-art knowledge of theory and practice in all functional fields of management and the ability to think critically, and apply them to diagnose and find solutions to organisational problems, even in unfamiliar or uncertain situations**

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : e. Attain theoretical and practical understanding of the functions and processes involved in managing an organization f. Develop critical thinking ability through analytical treatment of important contemporary problems and issues g. Acquire the ability to design approaches and use relevant models and tools to analyse situations and solve practical business problems h. Acquire the ability to persuasively recommend managerial solutions issuing from the process of decision analysis applied on managerial situation/s i. Acquire the ability to present a structured analysis of managerial situation/s using various strands of interpretations

2. Develop and apply ethical values to analyse and solve organisational problems

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Understand the realm of ethics (morality, values, ethos) and its importance to society b. Understand the issues of ethical importance specific to the domain of business c. Understand the role of manager/leader as an ethical individual and as a professional d. Understand the need and importance of institutionalizing Ethics within the organization e. Develop an understanding of corporation's duty to all the stakeholders f. Acquire the ability to appreciate the necessity of ethical practices for sustainable growth and profitability

3. Develop a global perspective that is built upon knowledge of economic, technological, regulatory and political forces that are shaping a new international order in the 21st century

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Familiarize with global factors/phenomenon affecting the business scenario

Learning Objectives
b. Acquire the ability to understand and comprehend issues and practices prevalent in the international arena c. Develop competence in analysing changes in international and domestic environment d. Respond to such changes through appropriate organizational decisions

4. Develop their capacity to articulate their thinking and ideas through verbal and written communications, at a professional (manager/consultant) level and to deliver the same

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : a. Acquire the ability to organize the thought process b. Demonstrate understanding of main points c. Acquire the ability to articulate the findings in a coherent and structured format to build a managerial case analysis d. Acquire the ability to customize messages/ solutions for diverse managerial situations **e.** Acquire the ability to deliver a professional quality formal presentation by exhibiting clarity and appropriate pace, coherent structure, credibility, effective use of visual aids, appropriate body language

5. Be able to appreciate the dynamics of Information Technology acquisition and absorption by present day business organizations and develop ability to use modern IT enabled decision support tools for improved understanding of business

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : g. Acquire the ability to learn various IT-enabled analytical tools , techniques and methods for solving problems h. Acquire familiarity of methods for comparing different state-of-the-art computing platforms i. Acquire the ability to use appropriate analytical techniques in a case setting to identify possibilities of deploying Information Technology for competitive advantage j. Acquire competence in use of IT tools in modelling managerial decision making situations

6. Acquire capacity to apply their professional knowledge and skills to diagnose and resolve business problems in actual organizational settings

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : c. Acquire the ability to identify organizational problems in both real life settings and through simulated situations d. Acquire the ability to interpret and apply knowledge of concepts e. Acquire the ability to design appropriate responses to solve identified problems by using appropriate tools, techniques & framework taught in courses

Learning Objectives
f. Acquire the ability to apply structured analytical thinking to solve an organizational problem

7. Acquire the leadership qualities and the competence needed for leading organizational change

Learning Objectives
Our students would be able to : c. Understand the theories of leadership d. Understand the theories of organizational change e. Demonstrate understanding of complex human issues arising from the implementation of change f. Understand individuals' and groups' behavior and motivation

Goal 1	Goal 2	Goal 3	Goal 4	Goal 5	Goal 6	Goal 7
Critical Thinking a, b, c, d, e	Acquiring Ethical Values a, b ,c ,d, e ,f	Acquiring Global Perspective a, b, c, d,	Ability to Articulate a, b, c, d, e	Technological Competencies a, b, c, d,	Problem Solving a, b, c, d,	Leadership Qualities a, b, c, d,
Applied Imagination	**Applied Imagination**		**Applied Imagination**		**Applied Imagination**	**Applied Imagination**